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YOUR LEARNING DESTINATION

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INTRODUCTION

This project is developed as part of the **Digital Literacy** course, where the role of a Student Digital Ambassador is simulated. The objective is to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio that demonstrates essential skills required to navigate the modern digital environment effectively. The project involves five structured tasks, including creating an **awareness infographic**, developing a **professional digital portfolio**, exploring **coding and collaboration platforms**, practicing **email etiquette**, and analyzing **cybercrime scenarios**. Through these activities, the project emphasizes responsible online behavior, professional communication, and awareness of digital risks. Overall, it reflects a practical approach to understanding how students can build a credible digital presence while ensuring safety, productivity, and ethical engagement in the digital world.

Task 1 – Infographic

For Task 1, I created a digital infographic titled *"Digital Literacy for Students: Tools, Safety & Online Presence."* The infographic presents key aspects of digital literacy, including its definition, useful digital tools, safe internet practices, and guidelines for maintaining a professional online presence. It highlights commonly used tools such as Google Docs, Notion, Grammarly, Canva, and video conferencing platforms, while also emphasizing cybersecurity practices like strong passwords, multi-factor authentication, and phishing awareness.

The infographic was designed using Canva, which provided an intuitive interface and a variety of templates, icons, and layout options. This made it easier to organize information visually and maintain a clean, professional design.

While creating this infographic, I found it interesting to condense multiple concepts into a single, visually appealing slide without making it cluttered. The main challenge was balancing content and design—ensuring clarity while still covering important points. This task helped me better understand how visual communication plays a crucial role in effectively conveying digital literacy concepts.

Task 2 – Digital Portfolio

For Task 2, I set up professional profiles on **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle** to establish a foundational digital presence. Each platform serves a distinct purpose in academic and professional development. **GitHub** is primarily used for version control and showcasing projects, making it essential for demonstrating coding skills and maintaining a portfolio. **LinkedIn** functions as a professional networking platform where I can present my educational background, connect with peers and professionals, and explore internship opportunities. **Kaggle**, on the other hand, is focused on data science and machine learning, providing access to datasets, competitions, and practical problem-solving environments.

Looking ahead, I plan to actively maintain and improve these profiles over the next four years. On GitHub, I intend to regularly upload projects and document my development process. On LinkedIn, I aim to build a strong professional network and engage with relevant content. For Kaggle, I plan to participate in competitions and enhance my analytical and problem-solving skills. Overall, these platforms will collectively support my academic growth and career readiness.

Task 3 – Platforms

For Task 3, I worked with two types of platforms: a coding practice platform and a collaboration tool. I created an account on HackerRank and completed the entire Python Introduction track. This involved solving beginner-level problems covering basic syntax, data types, loops, functions, and input/output handling. Through these exercises, I practiced writing structured code, improving logical thinking, and understanding how problem statements are translated into executable solutions.

In addition to coding practice, I used Google Forms to build a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz consisting of five questions. The quiz included a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions designed to test basic awareness of digital safety, tools, and online behavior. I also linked the form to a Google Sheet to automatically collect and organize responses, which demonstrates how data can be managed efficiently in a collaborative environment.

This task provided practical exposure to both technical and collaborative tools. While HackerRank strengthened my programming fundamentals, Google Forms helped me understand how to create interactive and data-driven resources that can be used in an academic setting.

Task 4 – Email Etiquette

For Task 4, I worked on two communication scenarios to demonstrate proper email etiquette. The first email was addressed to a college professor requesting an extension on an assignment deadline, while the second was written to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer internship in machine learning. Both emails were structured with clear subject lines, professional greetings, concise body content, and appropriate sign-offs.

Through this task, I learned the importance of clarity, tone, and structure in professional communication. A well-written email should be direct yet respectful, avoiding unnecessary details while clearly stating the purpose. I also understood the significance of maintaining a formal tone, especially when communicating with academic or professional authorities. Additionally, framing requests politely and providing relevant context improves the chances of a positive response. Overall, this task highlighted how effective digital communication reflects professionalism and creates a positive impression.

Poor digital Communication and its consequences- A common situation where poor digital communication causes problems is when a student sends an incomplete or unclear email to a professor regarding an important issue, such as assignment submission. For example, a student might send a message like "I can't submit on time, please help," without including details such as the course name, reason, or requested extension date. This lack of clarity can lead to confusion, delayed responses, or even rejection of the request, ultimately affecting the student's grades.

This issue could have been avoided by following proper email etiquette. The student should have used a clear subject line, addressed the professor respectfully, and provided a concise explanation with relevant details. Additionally, proposing a reasonable solution, such as a specific new deadline, would make the request more structured and professional. Clear and respectful communication ensures better understanding and increases the likelihood of a positive outcome.

Task 5 – Cybercrime

While researching ransomware, particularly the WannaCry attack, what surprised me most was how rapidly the malware was able to spread across entire networks without requiring user interaction. The fact that a single unpatched vulnerability could lead to large-scale disruption, even in critical sectors like healthcare, highlights how small oversights in cybersecurity can have severe consequences. I also found it notable that attackers often demand payment without guaranteeing data recovery, making victims vulnerable even after complying.

As a result of this research, one habit I will change is ensuring that all my software and systems are regularly updated. Previously, I tended to delay updates, but I now understand that they often contain critical security patches. Additionally, I will be more cautious with emails and downloads, especially from unknown sources, to reduce the risk of unintentionally introducing malware into my system.

Conclusion

This project provided a structured introduction to essential aspects of digital literacy, combining practical tasks with real-world relevance. Through the different modules, I developed a clearer understanding of how to create and manage a professional digital presence, communicate effectively in formal contexts, and use online tools for both learning and collaboration. The hands-on experience with platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, HackerRank, and Google Forms reinforced the importance of adaptability and continuous skill development in a digital environment. Additionally, exploring cybersecurity topics highlighted the risks associated with careless online behavior and the need for proactive safety measures. Overall, the project emphasized that digital literacy is not just about technical skills, but also about responsible, ethical, and informed participation in the digital world.

References

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